

Pb Action Portal

The public lead-analysis dashboard

Methodology & User Guide

Partnership for Battery Action (Pb Action)
Global Development Incubator (GDI)

A public, interactive dashboard for exploring how lead moves through the global economy — international trade, mining and refining, battery manufacturing, and end-of-life recycling. This document explains every tab, the calculations and assumptions behind each view, and how to use and adjust the model's inputs. All quantities are expressed in **metric tonnes of lead content** unless otherwise stated.

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1 Overview

The **Pb Action Portal** is the public Streamlit dashboard for the Partnership for Battery Action. It brings together several third-party datasets — harmonized international trade statistics, mine and refinery production figures, battery-collection data, and figures drawn from the published literature — and layers a set of interactive analyses on top of them, from bilateral trade maps to a country-level material-flow model. It is built for high-level analysis and pattern detection; every figure is expressed in tonnes of lead content so that trade, production, and recycling flows can be compared on a common basis.

1.1 No password; one-time disclaimer

There is no login or password gate — the app is public. The only interstitial is a one-time data-quality disclaimer with an “I understand — enter the app” button.

Data-quality disclaimer

The Portal draws on large, multi-source datasets — BACI trade statistics, BGS/USGS production figures, and model-derived estimates — each with known gaps and reporting errors. Results are useful for high-level analysis, rough estimates, and pattern detection, but should be cross-checked against primary sources before drawing conclusions.

1.2 Flat tab structure

The Portal presents **one flat level** of eight tabs:

Tab	What it shows
Trade Map	Bilateral BACI lead-trade flows on a world map
Trade Trends	Time series of imports/exports/production by country
Trade Relationships	Flow-network graph of who trades with whom
Lead Accumulation	Net lead balance (mining + imports – exports) over time
Production & Capacity	Where lead is mined, refined, and where batteries are made
Recycling Economy Snapshot (Beta)	Country recycling-economy overview (radar)
Material Flow (Beta)	Experimental per-country material-flow Sankey
Literature Stats	Searchable library of sourced datapoints

1.3 Units & interpretation

All values are in **metric tonnes of lead (Pb) content**; the Lead Accumulation and model tabs display in kilotonnes (kt Pb). Model-derived numbers are rounded to two significant figures for display.

1.4 Data sources

Data	Source
Bilateral trade flows	BACI / CEPII (harmonized UN Comtrade)
Mine & refined production	USGS, BGS

Data	Source
Battery collection	Eurostat, BCI, ILZSG, national studies
Literature figures	Published studies (per-figure citations on the Literature Stats tab)

1.5 Running & deploying

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
streamlit run streamlit_app.py
```

No password is required. Dependencies are `streamlit`, `pandas`, `numpy`, `plotly`, and `pyvis` (for the interactive Flow Network). All data the app needs ships in the repository, so no external downloads are required. The Portal is deployed on Streamlit Community Cloud from the GitHub repository `pb-action-portal`; it auto-redeploys on push to `main`.

2 View mode: Easy vs. Advanced

A **View mode** radio in the sidebar trades usability for control. It applies to all data tabs (tabs 1–7).

- **Easy mode** (default) fixes sensible assumptions and exposes only a *Center year* slider. The fixed assumptions — HS12 dataset, BGS source, 3-year centered average, default Pb factors with Slag and Other Lead Products excluded — are restated in grey at the bottom of each tab.
- **Advanced mode** exposes every input: dataset (HS12/HS22), mining source (BGS/USGS), single-year vs. 3-year period, per-HS Pb-content factors, and extra per-tab controls (colour modes, layouts, animation, process-parameter sliders).

The Easy-mode factor set is constructed to exactly match Advanced mode at its default widget states, so the two modes agree when Advanced is left at its defaults.

2.1 Datasets, sources, and time period

- **Dataset.** BACI from CEPII (harmonized UN Comtrade). *HS12 (2012–2024)* uses HS 2017 codes with waste-battery code 854810; *HS22 (2022–2024)* uses HS 2022 codes with the reclassified waste-battery code 854911.¹ Easy mode is always HS12.
- **Mining & refining source.** *BGS* (1971–2023, total refined, no primary/secondary split) or *USGS* (2015–2023, splits primary and secondary). When the selected source lacks a country/year, the app falls back to the other and shows a note.

¹**On using 854810 as a proxy for 854911.** HS12’s 854810 is a broad “all spent batteries” code, whereas HS22 introduced 854911 specifically for spent lead-acid batteries (ULABs). The historical (pre-2022) series therefore uses 854810 as a proxy for ULAB trade. Validated against the 2022–2024 overlap years (where BACI reports both nomenclatures), lead-acid makes up roughly 75–85% of the spent-battery block by weight (77–85% by value), confirming the proxy in direction and magnitude. However 854810 *overstates* ULAB tonnage — by about 10–25% near 2022 — because it also captures fast-growing lithium and other battery scrap; the proxy is cleaner (likely >90%) the further back you go. Applying a scaling factor of roughly 0.90–0.95 for earlier years, tapering toward 0.80–0.85 near 2022, sharpens the historical series. (The validation is partly circular, since BACI’s 2022–2024 854810 is itself back-converted from HS22 reports.)

- **Time period.** *Single year*, or a *3-year average* (recommended) over $[y - 1, y, y + 1]$ clipped to the data range; the average is annualised by summing flows and dividing by the number of years.

2.2 Pb-content factors

BACI reports gross product quantities; each HS code is multiplied by a Pb-content fraction. In Advanced mode every factor is an adjustable slider (bounded lo–hi) with a checkbox to exclude the code (factor 0.0). The canonical table:

HS code	Product	Category	Default	Lo	Hi
260700	Lead Ore & Concentrates	Mining Outputs	0.600	0.45	0.75
262021	Leaded Gasoline Residues	Slag	0.400	0.20	0.60
262029	Other Lead-Containing Residues	Slag	0.550	0.30	0.80
282410	Lead Monoxide	Battery Inputs	0.930	0.93	0.93
282490	Other Lead Oxides	Battery Inputs	0.900	0.87	0.93
780110	Refined Unwrought Lead	Battery Inputs	0.990	0.99	0.99
780191	Unwrought Lead (w/ Antimony)	Battery Inputs	0.960	0.94	0.98
780199	Other Unwrought Lead	Battery Inputs	0.970	0.95	0.99
780200	Lead Waste & Scrap	Battery Waste	0.725	0.50	0.95
780411	Lead Sheet/Strip/Foil (PCB)	Other Lead Products	0.990	0.99	0.99
780419	Lead Sheet/Strip/Foil (Other)	Other Lead Products	0.990	0.99	0.99
780420	Lead Tubes, Pipes & Fittings	Other Lead Products	0.985	0.98	0.99
780600	Other Lead Articles	Other Lead Products	0.970	0.95	0.99
850710	Lead-Acid Starter Batteries	New Batteries	0.600	0.55	0.65
850720	Other Lead-Acid Batteries	New Batteries	0.600	0.55	0.65
850790	Battery Parts	Battery Inputs	0.625	0.30	0.95
854810	Used Lead-Acid Batteries (HS12)	Battery Waste	0.600	0.55	0.65
854911	Spent Lead-Acid Battery Waste (HS22)	Battery Waste	0.600	0.55	0.65

Default-off codes. Slag (262021, 262029) and Other Lead Products (780411, 780419, 780420, 780600) are excluded by default; re-enable them in Advanced mode.

Where the sliders bite

The trade tabs read a pre-computed `actual_lead` column (HS12's baked-in `Pb Quantity`, or a fixed load-time factor $\times$ `Quantity` for HS22). The model tabs (Lead Accumulation, Production BOTECE, Recycling Snapshot, Material Flow) re-derive lead as `pb_factors[code]  $\times$  Quantity`, so the adjustable factors visibly change those views.

2.3 Regions

Places can be individual countries or regions. Region selectors list major regions (Africa, Americas, Asia, Europe, Oceania) first, then UN sub-regions, then countries A–Z. Regional trade views show cross-region (external) flows only.

3 Trade tabs

3.1 Trade Map

What it shows. A Plotly choropleth of BACI lead-trade for the selected place, plus Top-30 partner tables. *All countries* colours each country by net position (exports – imports, signed-log normalised, red = net importer, green = net exporter); a single country colours its partners; a region colours its external partners (cross-region flows only).

Calculations. The single-country “global volume scale” multiplies a balance ratio (net/total bilateral) by a log-intensity term so small flows stay pale; the “bilateral trade balance” mode plots the ratio alone (volume-independent), purple = pure receiver, orange = pure sender.

Controls. *Select a country or region* (default All countries); *Color scale mode* (Advanced, non-All: Global volume scale / Bilateral trade balance); *Product selection* — Easy shows the five trade-category checkboxes, Advanced per-HS checkboxes grouped by six material-flow categories (Slag and Other Lead Products off by default).

3.2 Trade Trends

What it shows. Line charts of import/export volume (or production) over time, for one place (Easy) or up to three (Advanced).

Calculations. Trade series sum `actual_lead` by year for the chosen category’s HS codes (raw annual values — not subject to the 3-year window). Production series come from BGS or USGS with automatic source fallback. The Relative view plots year-on-year % change.

Controls. *Country / Region* slots; *Series* multiselect (default Total Lead-Related Imports & Exports); *View absolute/relative* (Advanced); *Shared y-axis* toggle (Advanced).

3.3 Trade Relationships (Flow Network)

What it shows. A node-link graph: bubble size $\propto \sqrt{\text{total trade volume}}$, arrow width $\propto \sqrt{\text{flow volume}}$, arrows coloured by category. An interactive draggable view (default) or a static Plotly figure.

Controls. *View mode* (Advanced); *Select countries* (default India, China, USA); *Minimum flow* (Advanced 100–10000, default 500; Easy fixed 100); *Layout* (default geographic centroids; Advanced adds Grid and Force-directed); *Focal country*; *Region cluster*, *Flow direction*, *Use all years*, and *Hide country pairs* (all Advanced); product selection as on the Trade Map.

4 Model & material-flow tabs

4.1 Lead Accumulation

What it shows. A cumulative net-lead line chart since the 2012 base year, a per-category net bar for the selected year, and a diverging world map of every country’s net balance (Advanced adds an annual bar, metric tiles, and an HS-code table).

Calculation.

$$\text{Net} = \text{Mining} + \text{Imports}_{\text{pb}} - \text{Exports}_{\text{pb}},$$

where mining is mine production plus net ore trade (260700), and trade is converted with the adjustable Pb factors (unknown codes default 0.70). Positive = net accumulator, negative = net depleter. The world map uses a diverging red–green scale centred at zero, clipped at the 95th percentile of magnitude.

Controls. *Select country or region* (default Ghana); inherits the sidebar year, dataset, Pb factors, and mining source.

A trade-based approximation

Net balance does not account for domestic consumption, stockpiles, or informal flows; 2024 data is incomplete.

4.2 Production & Capacity

What it shows. A log-scale choropleth of one of four datasets, with a ranked table for reported datasets and (Advanced) an animated time-lapse.

Dataset	Type	Source / metric
Lead Mining	reported	BGS or USGS mine production
Lead Refining	reported	BGS total refined, or USGS primary + secondary
Battery Manufacturing (BOTECH)	model	F4_batt_lead (see engine)
Battery Consumption (BOTECH)	model	F5_implied (see engine)

Calculations. Reported datasets are pulled from an outer-join of separate USGS and BGS extracts (never reconciled). The two BOTECH datasets run the material-flow engine (Section 4.5) once per eligible country.

Controls. *Dataset* radio; *Animated* toggle (Advanced); *Year* slider (Advanced); a page-local BGS/USGS radio in Easy mode; a *Process parameters* expander for the BOTECH datasets in Advanced.

4.3 Recycling Economy Snapshot (Beta)

What it shows. Side-by-side radar (“diamond”) charts comparing countries (up to three in Advanced, two in Easy) on four recycling axes — Collection, Breaking, Secondary Smelting, Manufacturing (optionally plus Mining). A perfectly circular economy plots as an equilateral diamond.

Calculation. Axis values are material-flow engine outputs (B4_collected, B2_break_out, eff_secondary, F4_batt_lead, mined) computed with *default* process parameters — the Advanced sliders do not apply here. An optional Collection Baseline marks the “perfect loop” reference.

Controls. Country selectboxes (defaults Germany, USA); Advanced toggles for Mining axis, Collection Baseline, and Same scale. In Easy mode the baseline is always on.

4.4 Material Flow (Beta)

What it shows. A per-country material-flow Sankey (collection → breaking → secondary smelting → manufacturing → installation), with per-commodity trade nodes and (Advanced) a model-output table.

Controls. *Select country* (restricted to countries with refining data); *Min flow threshold* (Advanced, default 10 t Pb; Easy fixed 10); the full *Process parameters* expander in Advanced. Advanced draws gross import/export nodes; Easy nets each commodity unless both directions exceed the threshold.

4.5 The material-flow engine

Four of the tabs are powered by one underlying model: the **Material Flow Sankey**, the **Recycling Economy Snapshot**, and the two BOTE datasets on **Production & Capacity** (Battery Manufacturing and Battery Consumption). Understanding this engine explains most of what those tabs show.

What it is — in plain terms. For a single country and year, the model reconstructs the whole lead cycle — from batteries being collected at the end of their life, through recycling, all the way to new batteries being made and put into service. It works by starting from one quantity we can actually measure (how much lead that country’s smelters produced from scrap) and reasoning outward in both directions: trade data accounts for what crosses borders, and a short list of efficiency assumptions accounts for the losses at each step. It is a single, transparent pass of arithmetic — not a statistical fit — so every output can be traced straight back to its inputs.

The anchor. The one firmly-measured quantity is a country’s **secondary (scrap-based) smelting output**, reported by BGS or USGS. Everything else is estimated relative to it. Anchoring on a real, reported number keeps the whole chain tied to observed production rather than to a tower of assumptions. (A country that reports no refining at all cannot be anchored and is skipped.)

Two pieces of notation below: for each traded product, “imports” and “exports” are that country’s trade in it (in tonnes of lead content), and the Greek letters are the efficiency/share parameters listed in the table further down.

Working backward — from the smelter up to collection. Moving *up* the recycling chain, each step asks: how much had to enter this stage for the next stage’s figure to come out? That means dividing by an efficiency (to undo the losses) and adjusting for net trade of the material at that stage.

anchor = reported secondary smelting output

$$B_1 \text{ (scrap into smelters)} = \text{anchor} / \eta_{\text{secondary}}$$

$$B_2 \text{ (lead recovered by breaking)} = \max(0, B_1 - \text{imports}_{\text{scrap}} + \text{exports}_{\text{scrap}})$$

$$B_3 \text{ (used batteries broken)} = B_2 / (\delta \cdot \eta_{\text{break}})$$

$$B_4 \text{ (used batteries collected)} = \max(0, B_3 - \text{imports}_{\text{used}} + \text{exports}_{\text{used}})$$

$$B_5 \text{ (end-of-life batteries generated)} = B_4 / \gamma$$

$$B_6 \text{ (uncollected / disposed)} = B_5 \cdot (1 - \gamma)$$

In words: the scrap the smelters consumed (B_1) must have come from domestic battery-breaking plus net imported scrap (B_2); that recovered lead implies a larger quantity of used batteries fed in, before breaking and end-of-life losses (B_3); those came from batteries collected at home plus net trade in used batteries (B_4); and the collected amount is only a fraction γ (the collection rate) of all the batteries that actually reached end of life (B_5), the remainder being lost or dumped (B_6).

Working forward — from feedstock down to new batteries. From the total refined metal available, the model moves *down* the manufacturing chain:

$$\text{feedstock} = \text{primary metal} + \text{secondary metal} + \text{net refined \& crude imports}$$

$$F_2 \text{ (lead into non-battery uses)} = \text{feedstock} \cdot (1 - \beta)$$

$$F_3 \text{ (lead routed to batteries)} = \text{feedstock} \cdot \beta$$

$$F_4 \text{ (lead in batteries made)} = \max(0, F_3) \cdot \eta_{\text{mfg}}$$

$$F_5 \text{ (implied battery consumption)} = F_4 + \text{imports}_{\text{batt}} - \text{exports}_{\text{batt}}$$

In words: the metal a country has to work with (feedstock) is its own refined output plus net imports of refined feedstock and crude lead (crude is first de-rated by a refining recovery η_{refine}); a share β of that goes into batteries and the rest into other lead products (F_2/F_3); manufacturing losses reduce it to the lead actually embodied in new batteries (F_4); and adding net battery trade gives the lead in batteries *put into service* domestically (F_5).

Where the primary/secondary split comes from. The anchor has to be divided between metal made from ore (primary) and metal made from scrap (secondary). Estimated primary metal is domestic ore (mined + imports_{ore} – exports_{ore}) times a smelting recovery η_{ore} ; if that comes to less than 5% of reported refined output, the model treats *all* refined lead as secondary. When USGS data is selected, its reported primary/secondary split is used directly instead.

Key assumptions — read before trusting a number

The engine is a back-of-the-envelope (BOTE) estimate, deliberately simple. In particular it assumes: (1) **steady state** — a single trade year is treated as if the system were in balance, with no time lag between batteries sold and batteries returned; (2) **one aggregate flow** — there is no split between formal and informal recycling, which in reality can change the efficiencies at every step; (3) **global default efficiencies** — the recovery and collection rates are literature midpoints applied to every country until you change them; (4) **trade as a clean proxy** — traded scrap, used batteries, and feedstock are assumed to be correctly classified and measured, so any gaps or misclassifications in the underlying trade data flow straight through; and (5) **no reconciliation** — it is a single deterministic pass, not a model solved for overall consistency against independent stock data. Outputs are rounded to two significant figures and labelled Beta in-app.

Adjustable parameters (Advanced mode). Each stage's efficiency or share is a slider. The defaults are neutral starting points, *not* country-specific values.

Parameter	Symbol	Range	Default
Secondary smelting recovery	$\eta_{\text{secondary}}$	0.80–1.00	0.97
Breaking recovery	η_{break}	0.70–1.00	0.95
Pb retained at end-of-life	δ	0.80–1.00	0.95
Battery share of lead demand	β	0.50–1.00	0.85
Manufacturing efficiency	η_{mfg}	0.90–1.00	0.98
Primary smelting recovery	η_{ore}	0.80–1.00	0.95
Refining recovery (crude lead)	η_{refine}	0.80–1.00	0.97
Collection rate	γ	0.30–1.00	0.95

Start from the defaults, then tune for each country

Every parameter ships with a single *global* default (for example, the collection rate $\gamma = 0.95$), applied identically to every country. Real-world values differ enormously: collection rates alone range from roughly 0.99 in the USA and Japan, to about 0.70 in India, to around 0.60 in Nigeria — and the battery share of lead demand, breaking and smelting recoveries, and end-of-life retention vary just as much. The out-of-the-box numbers are therefore *illustrative*, not a country-specific answer. For any serious analysis, switch to Advanced mode, open *Process parameters*, and set at least the collection rate (γ), the battery share (β), and the recovery efficiencies to values appropriate for the country and year you are studying. The Sankey and snapshot update immediately, so you can see how sensitive the picture is to each assumption.

5 Literature Stats

What it shows. A searchable, read-only library of quantitative datapoints from the lead-battery literature, each tied to a source citation (reading `data/literature_datapoints.csv`). Internal model-variable codes are hidden and mapped to plain-English topics (Collection & ULAB volumes, Recycling efficiency, Battery composition, Lead demand, Trade flows, Health & environmental exposure, and so on).

Controls. A *Search* box; *Topic*, *Geography*, and *Evidence type* multiselects; a *Year* slider with an “Include undated / multi-year” toggle. Results appear in a sortable, single-select table; clicking a row opens a detail panel with the verbatim quote and APA citation. A CSV download exports friendly columns. The only aggregation shown is the count of matching statistics.

Submission form is built but disabled

The Portal contains a full visitor-submission form (`literature/submit.py`) that would write new datapoints to a Google Sheet for review, with an offline CSV/mailto fallback. It is currently *disabled*: the `render_submission_form()` call and its import are commented out in `literature/app.py`, and `gsread` / `google-auth` are commented out in `requirements.txt`. To re-enable it: uncomment those lines, restore the two dependencies, and configure the secrets (see `.streamlit/secrets.toml.example`).